



CHICAGO'S TOP WORKPLACES

Despite some return-to-office mandates, hybrid and remote work isn't going away. **Special section inside**

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BREAKING NEWS AT CHICAGOTRIBUNE.COM

Chicago Tribune

Flights canceled under FAA order

Service reductions at 40 airports will ripple nationwide

By Josh Funk and Rio Yamat
Associated Press

U.S. airlines began canceling hundreds of flights Thursday due to the Federal Aviation Administration's order to reduce traffic at the country's busiest airports starting Friday because of the government shutdown.

More than 500 flights scheduled for Friday were already cut nationwide, and the number of cancellations climbed steadily throughout Thursday, according to FlightAware, a website that tracks flight disruptions.

The FAA order to cut flights at 40 of the busiest airports across the U.S. includes New York, Los Angeles and Chicago, according to a list distributed to the airlines and obtained by The Associated Press. But the impact will disrupt travel at many smaller airports too.

The FAA seeks to reduce service by 10% across "high-volume" markets to maintain travel safety as air traffic controllers exhibit signs of strain during the shutdown. The move also comes as the Trump administration is ramping up pressure on Democrats in Congress to end the shutdown.

Airlines will phase in the 10% reduction in their flight schedules at the airports across more than two dozen states. Just hours before the reductions went into place, airlines were scrambling to figure out where to cut and some travelers began changing or canceling itineraries preemptively.

Travelers with plans for the weekend and beyond waited

Turn to Flights, Page 2

O'Hare and Midway hit with flight reductions

By Talia Soglin and Robert McCoppin
Chicago Tribune

Both Chicago's O'Hare International and Midway airports are among those affected by government shutdown-related flight reductions planned to start Friday.

On Wednesday, the Federal Aviation Administration said it would reduce flights by 10% across 40 "high-volume" markets to maintain the safety of air travel as the federal government shutdown — now the longest in U.S. history — drags on.

The FAA's announcement comes as President Donald Trump's administration ramps up pressure on Democrats in Congress to end the shutdown. Democrats have thus far refused to acquiesce to Republican attempts to pass a funding measure that doesn't extend enhanced subsidies for Affordable Care Act exchange health insurance.

Air traffic controllers are working without pay during the shutdown, and staffing issues at air traffic towers have caused flight delays throughout the country.

On Thursday — before the scheduled reduction in air traffic on Friday — a ground delay was scheduled to take effect at O'Hare in the late afternoon. Delays were expected to average 73 minutes and top out at more than two hours later in the evening, according to an FAA advisory.

The stated cause? Staffing. In a statement, the Chicago Department of Aviation said it was "coordinating with federal and

Turn to Airports, Page 2



Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino, center, walks with other agents while conducting an immigration enforcement sweep in Chicago's Brighton Park neighborhood on Thursday. **ARMANDO L. SANCHEZ/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Judge: 'The use of force shocks the conscience'

Sweeping injunction issued on tactics of immigration raids in Chicago

By Jason Meisner
Chicago Tribune

A federal judge in Chicago on Thursday issued a sweeping injunction that puts more permanent restrictions on the use of force by immigration agents during "Operation Midway Blitz," saying top government officials lied in their testimony about threats that protesters posed and that their unlawful behavior on the streets "shows no signs of stopping."

"I find the government's

evidence to be simply not credible," U.S. District Judge Sara Ellis said in an oral ruling from the bench, describing a litany of incidents over the past month and a half where citizens were tear-gassed "indiscriminately," beaten and tackled by agents and struck in the face with pepper-spray balls.

"The use of force shocks the conscience," Ellis said.

The judge noted in particular that Border Patrol Cmdr. Gregory Bovino lied repeatedly in his deposition testimony about force

that his agents and he himself personally inflicted in incidents across the Chicago area.

"In one of the videos, Bovino obviously attacks and tackles the declarant, Mr. Blackburn, to the ground," Ellis said. "But Mr. Bovino, despite watching this video (in his deposition) says that he never used force."

The preliminary injunction largely mirrors — and replaces — a temporary restraining order issued by Ellis in early October that was set to expire at 11:30 a.m. Thursday. She instructed

the government to notify each agency of its details and disseminate it to employees by no later than 10 p.m. Thursday.

The judge said she'd put out a more fulsome written ruling at a later time, but for now, it enjoins immigration agents from deploying tear gas or other munitions before issuing two explicit warnings, requires agents in the field to have body-worn cameras and wear clear identification on their uniforms and forbids law

Turn to Injunction, Page 4



Hannah Bradbury, leader of the training group North Avenue Swim & Triathlon Yo!, known as NASTY, reacts to the temperature after wrapping up training in Lake Michigan on Thursday at North Avenue Beach in Chicago. **DOMINIC DI PALERMO/CHICAGO TRIBUNE**

Lake Michigan water temperatures remain abnormally warm into fall

By Jerry Wu
Chicago Tribune

On a crisp October day, Hannah Bradbury was still leading open-water practices in Lake Michigan for her swimming and triathlon organization.

Usually, her thrill-seeking training group — the North Avenue Swim & Triathlon Yo!, known as NASTY — wraps up in September, when the water gets too cold for most

members, she said. But this year's practice stretched a month longer.

Lake Michigan was unusually warm in October, with the average surface water temperature in October hovering around 4½ degrees higher than the 30-year average of just over 57 degrees, according to data from the National Oceanic and Atmospheric Administration. That warmth continued into November. This week, Lake Michigan's

surface water temperature was around 55 degrees, still several degrees above average.

By this time of year, Bradbury said she usually doesn't notice much difference between the temperature on the surface and the bottom because cold air has generally cooled the surface.

"From where I dive, I try to touch the bottom of the lake, and there's a very noticeable

Turn to Lake, Page 9

INSIDE

Social media drama snares Bears receiver

Rome Odunze's father caught some attention on social media suggesting the Bears should trade him. But Odunze says he's happy with the team. **Chicago Sports**

Pelosi decides not to seek reelection

Nancy Pelosi, who served as the first female speaker of the House, will retire after nearly 40 years of service. **Nation & World**

Mr. Submarine celebrates 50 years

The Chicago-area sub shop will mark a half-century with 50 new commercials and 99-cent sub sandwiches. **Business**

TODAY'S WEATHER

High **62**
Low **41**



Complete Chicagoland forecast on Page 12

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